What changed this week

Elections in the US, Serbia, Israel and Brazil, and new strikes around the Strait of Hormuz.



How to read the threat scale

- 1. Low
- 2. Guarded
- 3. Elevated
- 4. High
- 5. Severe

Each grade reflects how likely an issue is to disrupt people, assets or operations in the next three months, and how badly.

Swipe to see all five →



United States

Threat level 3 of 5

Elevated

A party to the Iran war, now facing a Congress under Democratic control.

Top three issues

1 Iran war decisions — High

US forces struck Iranian targets on Qeshm Island on 2 November. President Trump says he is in no rush to decide whether to resume full-scale fighting.

2 Divided government — Elevated

Democrats won both the House and Senate on 3 November, as called by CBS News and NBC News, setting up clashes with the White House over war powers, budgets and trade.

3 Trade and tariff policy — Elevated

Tariffs and frequent policy shifts keep supply chains uncertain for partners.



Iran

Threat level 5 of 5
Severe

At war with the US and Israel since 28 February. Hormuz is effectively closed while Qatari mediators test a deal to reopen it.

Top three issues

1 Renewed US strikes — Severe

US forces struck Qeshm Island on 2 November after Iranian fire at a US aircraft. US officials say other strikes have been carried out quietly in recent weeks.

2 Strait of Hormuz closure — Severe

Transits are down to a handful a day against about 85 before the war, as Iran shifts to mines and small-boat attacks. Tehran says it could reopen the strait within two days if Washington meets its conditions.

3 Fragile diplomacy — High

Qatari mediators in Tehran are pushing a framework where Iran stops attacking ships and the US lifts its port blockade, but officials say the two sides remain far apart.



Serbia

Threat level 2 of 5

Guarded

A student-led list won a parliamentary majority on 25 October, ending Aleksandar Vučić's long dominance.

Top three issues

1 Transfer of power — Elevated

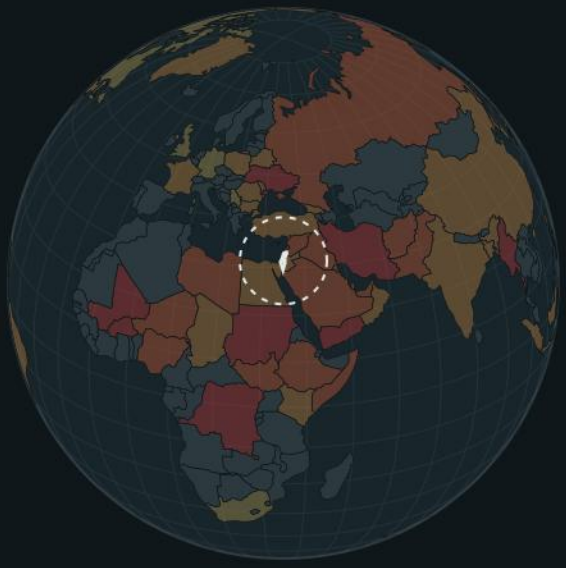
Vučić conceded after the Student List won about 54% of the vote. Forming a government from a new, untested movement will take time.

2 Kosovo — Elevated

Tensions in northern Kosovo can flare quickly, and a new government's approach is not yet known.

3 Foreign policy reset — Guarded

A new government may shift Belgrade's balance between the EU and Russia, with knock-on effects for energy deals and EU accession.



Israel

Threat level 4 of 5
High

Engaged on several fronts, with no clear winner from the 27 October election.

Top three issues

1 Return to war with Iran — Severe

Netanyahu has pushed for another wave of strikes on Iran. A new exchange would bring Iranian missile fire back onto Israeli cities and infrastructure.

2 Northern front with Hezbollah — High

The IDF is striking in Lebanon again while Iran is reported to have raised Hezbollah's readiness.

3 Coalition deadlock — Elevated

Likud came first on 27 October, but neither bloc has a clear Knesset majority. Coalition talks will set policy on Iran, Lebanon and Gaza.



Brazil

Threat level 3 of 5

Elevated

Lula won a fourth term, but his opponent has not conceded.

Top three issues

1 **Disputed runoff result** — Elevated

Lula beat Flávio Bolsonaro in the 25 October runoff with about 52% of the vote. Bolsonaro says he will seek annulment, though his own Liberal Party recognised the result.

2 **US tariffs** — Elevated

Tariffs and political disputes with Washington hit exporters.

3 **Fiscal credibility** — Guarded

Spending pressures test the fiscal framework.



Explore all 65 countries

Spin the globe, click any country, and see its threat level and the three issues behind it.

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admin@faultlinerisk.com